

**Justification Review Document For Sole Source –
FAR Part 13.501 (Format follows FAR 6.303-2, but modified to
reflect FAR subpart 13.5 procedures)**

Program/Equipment: 2nd Theater Signal Brigade Base Communications Wireless
Mobility Services in Italy

Authority: Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Services, 41 U.S.C. 1901 as
implemented by FAR Subpart 13.5

Amount: 452,461.80 EUR / 489,200.78 USD

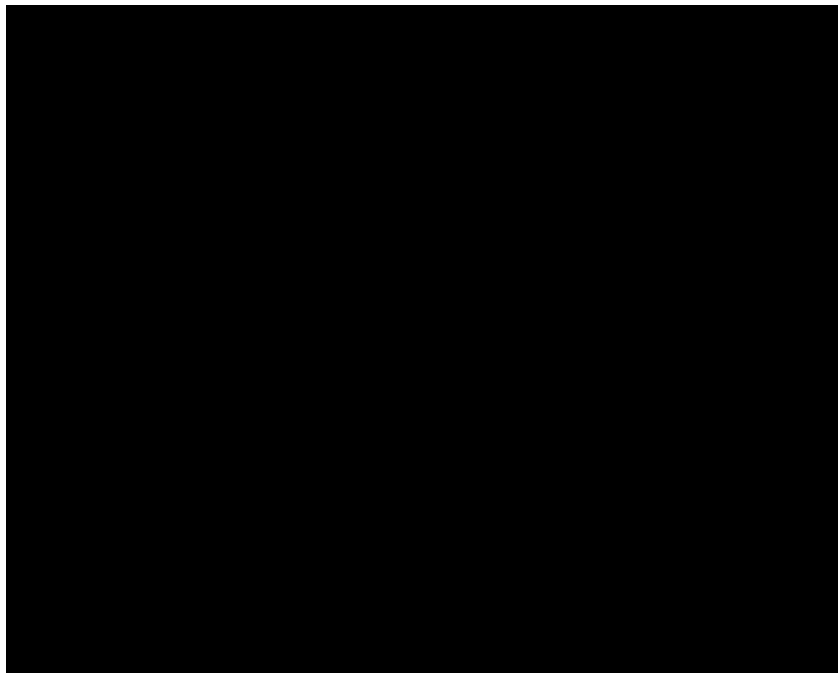
Base PoP: 13 April 2025 – 12 April 2026 (12 months of service)

Prepared by:

Contracting Officer:

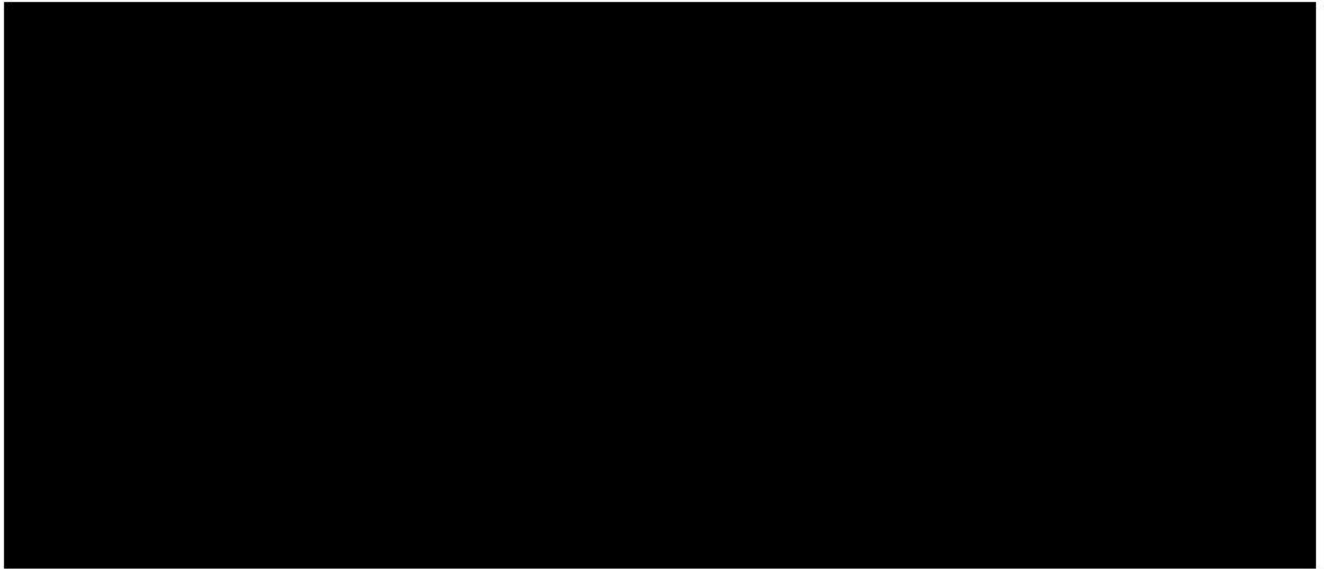
Technical:

Requirements:



Reviews

I have reviewed this justification and find it adequate to support other than full and open competition.



**Justification Review Document For Sole Source –
FAR Part 13.501 (Format follows FAR 6.303-2, but modified to
reflect FAR subpart 13.5 procedures)**

1. **Contracting Activity:** 409th Contracting Support Brigade – Theater Contracting Center (409th CSB – TCC)
2. **Description of Action:** 2nd Theater Signal Brigade (2TSB) is requesting a bridge contract for continuation of services that are currently provided under BPA Call Order W564KV-23-F-0148. [REDACTED] is providing 2,745 users with the following wireless services: 2,745 x SIMs, 36 x Unlimited Voice & Text with Data (100GB), 2,209 x Unlimited Voice & Text with Data (20GB), and 500 x Data Only (20GB). To continue to fulfill Base Communications (BASECOM) Wireless Mobility Services, a sole-source award needs to be made to the incumbent to prevent a break in service while the Government works on solutions and different approaches for future requirements.

Funds: Operations & Maintenance, Army (OMA)

Name of Proposed Contractor(s) and Address:



[REDACTED]

3. **Description of Supplies/Services:** 2TSB and its customers in Italy require uninterrupted and reliable wireless communication services for its approximately 2,745 users across various mission-critical operations. These wireless services are vital for daily operations, ensuring seamless command and control for Army personnel, civilians, and host nation employees in [REDACTED]. [REDACTED] will deliver 2,745 users with 2,745 SIMs and the following wireless services: 36 x Unlimited Voice & Text with Data (100GB), 2,209 x Unlimited Voice & Text with Data (20GB), and 500 x Data Only (20GB). Continuing service with [REDACTED] is critical due to the recent and complex migration from [REDACTED] completed on 31 January 2025. The recent transition to [REDACTED] detailed in BPA Call Order W564KV-23-F-0148, encountered unforeseen challenges, delaying completion until 31 January 2025. These challenges highlight the complexity of managing wireless services for a large user base (2,745) dispersed across challenging geographical locations [REDACTED]. Factors including Timeframe, Recent SIM Migration, Geographical Context, Scale and Scope, Mission-Critical Support, Scale and Complexity, Geographical Dispersion, and Manual Processes all contribute to the challenges of this requirement necessitating the sole-source award.

Base PoP of proposed sole-source award: 13 April 2025 – 12 April 2026 (12-months of services)

Total Amount: 452,461.80 EUR / 489,200.78 USD

- 4. Authority Cited:** Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Services, 41 U.S.C. 1901 as implemented by FAR Subpart 13.5

5. Reason for Authority Cited:

- a. 2TSB and its partners in Italy rely on uninterrupted, dependable wireless communication for approximately 2,745 users executing mission-critical operations in [REDACTED]. Many times, these end users may report to a command in the aforementioned locations but are actively carrying out their duties in support of missions in other locations. These vital communication services underpin seamless command and control for Army personnel, civilians, and host nation employees across the region. The recent transition of wireless services for the 2TSB from [REDACTED] to [REDACTED] while ultimately successful, faced significant challenges and delays due to the complex logistical demands of migrating a large user base with mission-critical communication needs across geographically dispersed locations in [REDACTED]. This experience underscores the importance of service stability and the potential risks of undertaking another disruptive migration in such a short timeframe. [REDACTED]

- b. As already referenced, the recent transition to [REDACTED] encountered various challenges which ultimately delayed completion of the service transition until 31 January 2025, taking up to five (05) months of the period of performance. As a result of the complex nature of a requirement of this type and size, which creates a wide-ranging list of challenges from factors such as timeframe, geographical context, scale and scope, mission-critical support, etc. the 2TSB, in an effort to prevent these issues in the future, will implement enhanced line tracking and a phase-in period for the follow-on contract. Further details regarding the factors previously mentioned that contributed to the need for a sole-source bridge contract can be found below:

- (1) Timeframe: A mere one (01) year and four (04) months have passed since the last migration. This short timeframe amplifies the risks associated with another migration. Systems and processes might not be fully stabilized, and personnel likely haven't fully recovered from the logistical and technical challenges of the previous transition.
- (2) Recent SIM Migration: The fact that a SIM migration from [REDACTED] to [REDACTED] was just completed on 31 January 2025 is crucial. As further outlined in the points below, this recent transition indicates that 2TSB's systems and end users are still adapting to the new network infrastructure.
- (3) Geographical Context: [REDACTED] often lack robust and consistent telecommunications infrastructure compared to more

- (4) Scale and Scope: 2,745 end users are a significant number, and managing a SIM swap for such a large user base across diverse geographical locations presents substantial logistical hurdles. Furthermore, user engagement in real-world missions adds another layer of complexity to a prospective changeover in service. These missions often involve time-sensitive operations, demanding seamless and reliable communication.
- (5) Mission-Critical Support: 2TSB's Telecommunications Ordering Officers (TOOs) had the added responsibility of ensuring uninterrupted connectivity for end users engaged in real-world missions. This often involved troubleshooting connectivity issues, further diverting resources and time from the last transition process.
- (6) Scale and Complexity: The SIM transition involved a considerable number of SIMs and eSIMs, which is a significant undertaking.
- (7) Geographical Dispersion: [REDACTED] added logistical complexities to the transition process.
- (8) Manual Processes: [REDACTED] requirement for manual input of SIM serial numbers into an Excel sheet for number porting, while necessary for maintaining existing numbers, created a labor-intensive process. This manual approach, coupled with the need to coordinate with 2,745 end users individually, significantly impacted the timeline.

- c. 2TSB plays a critical role in enabling U.S. Government operations in Italy through its provision of essential BASECOM support. Wireless services are vital to daily operations, ensuring seamless command and control for 2,745 cell phone lines currently supporting personnel south of the Alps. The consequences of losing these wireless services would be catastrophic, effectively resulting in mission failure across numerous commands and organizations. [REDACTED]

the impact of unreliable wireless services would be felt across a diverse range of critical functions, impacting the following:



The wide range of affected organizations underscores the absolute necessity of uninterrupted wireless communication for the success of U.S. missions in Italy.

- d. 2TSB, the 409th CSB – TCC, and end users TOO's are working towards solutions and the development of evaluation criteria and migration plans for future requirements competed amongst the wireless services BPA holders. There are several variables and unknowns tied to mission requirements for individual service line users that prevent pinpointing a set timeframe needed to complete a competitive re-compete effort. However, the 409th CSB – TCC determined a 12-month period of performance is required at a minimum to meet mission needs and avoid migration issues in the future.

Within the 12-month period of performance, the 409th CSB – TCC in coordination with 2TSB and the service line end user TOO's will address the following milestones to ensure the flow of information and mission success.

- (1) A list item labeled (1) is followed by a large redacted block. Two right-pointing arrows are visible to the left of the redacted block, indicating sub-points or a list structure.



Additionally, the 12-month period of performance allows for the Government to consider the following actions/responsibilities for inclusion in the re-compete as a means of enhancing communication and flow of information:

- (1) Ensure Customer Service Support provides solutions within 24 hours from trouble ticket submissions.
- (2) Service Providers will need to make available consumption/usage/fees reports at request of customer unit representatives within 72 hours of the request.
- (3) Access to Service Provider Web Portal for all TOO Unit Representatives in effort to review current and previous invoice information by SIM/Phone Number.

- (4) Service Providers must provide good service coverage when customers are required to use Roaming Services in External EU Countries (Africa, Balkans, Poland, and EU Locations service degradation).

- e. Based on the tasks noted above the Government will follow the timeline below to work the re-compete:



- f. To prevent future issues with migration and solicitation, 2TSB will implement the following safeguards for all future BPAs:

- (1) Enhanced Line Tracking: TOOs will implement weekly vendor check-ins to verify the status of all migrated lines. TOOs will also maintain a current and accurate inventory of active SIM cards and required wireless service plans to support future RFQ processes.
- (2) Phase-in Period: Future BPA Call Orders will include a phase-in period to provide adequate time for the seamless migration of lines from the previous vendor to a newly awarded vendor (if applicable).

- 6. Efforts to Obtain Competition:** Presently, there are four (04) BPAs set up to provide wireless services. The issues described above necessitating the continued use of the current service provider for the next 12 months explain why those BPAs

cannot be used for this requirement. The Government intends to solicit the re-compete effort competitively through local sources. This justification will be posted in accordance with the requirements of FAR Part 5.201 and 6.305.

a. Effective competition. The Government intends to award a new Purchase Order to the incumbent Contractor as a means of maintaining performance of the required services, while the competitive follow-on effort is pursued and awarded.

b. Subcontracting competition. n/a

- 7. Actions to Increase Competition:** No additional actions are being taken to increase competition for the follow-on contract, though the re-compete is anticipated to garner adequate interest for sufficient competition. Historically, there has been sufficient competition for these services. However, as discussed above, with the exception of the incumbent contractor, no other firms are in a position to begin the full range of performance by 12 April 2025 in the current timeline of procuring the follow-on effort.
- 8. Market Research:** Market research has been ongoing since the inception of this requirement and continuing during the drafting of this document, conducted by both the requiring activity and contracting office. The contracting office has four wireless services BPAs in place and previous Call Orders issued against those BPAs resulted from competition amongst all four BPA Holders. The Requiring Activity and Contracting Officer will review other available sources, on SAM and through PCF, to develop solutions for future competition of this requirement.
- 9. Interested Sources:** No contractors other than the current service provider and current BPA awardees have expressed direct interest in this procurement. As described above, the other contractors available under the current BPA program do not have the capacity to provide the services given the timeline, mission requirements, and need for uninterrupted service. These contractors would need the time to transition the lines, a process that previously took 16 months to complete, as discussed in paragraph 5 above.

10. Other Facts:

a. Procurement history

(1) Contract Number: W91RUS-22-P-0064

- Description: Wireless Services Italy
- Awardee: [REDACTED]
- Base PoP: 01 July 2022 – 31 March 2023
- Options: Three (03) one-month option periods to extend services through 30 June 2023
- Total Value: \$2,517,283.71
- Procurement Method: Sole Source (Bridge Contract)

(2) Contract Number: W564KV-23-F-0148

- Description: Wireless Services Italy
- Awardee: [REDACTED]
- Base PoP: 13 September 2023 – 12 April 2024
- Options: One (01) twelve-month option period from 13 April 2024 to 12 April 2025
- Total Value: \$753,463.77.
- Procurement Method: Competed under SAP

11. Technical/Requirements Certification: I certify that the supporting data under my cognizance, which are included in the justification are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.



12. Fair and Reasonable Price Determination & Contracting Officer Certification: I hereby determine that the anticipated price to the Government for this contract action will be fair and reasonable based upon:

a. This determination will be made using the following:

☒ Price analysis

☐ Cost Analysis

☒ IGE

☐ Other: _____

b. Specifically, one or more of the price analysis techniques for commercial items found in FAR Part 15.404-1(a) to complete evaluation of the price and determine reasonableness. If price reasonableness cannot be determined using price analysis of Government obtained information, additional information in accordance with FAR Part 15.402(a) may be required from the Contractor to support the proposed price.

c. I certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief, and that completing this purchase as a sole source is in the best interest of the Government.

GUTIERREZ.ISRAEL

Digitally signed by

GUTIERREZ.ISRAEL

Date: 2025.04.08 14:02:55 +02'00'

EL

Date: See Digital Signature

Israel Gutierrez
Contracting Officer